

1 · THE TWO CUE TYPES — WHEN TO USE EACH

▲ MEMORY CUE = YOUR MAP

Use to **navigate** the track and know **when to mix**.

- Mark every section start (intro, build, drop, breakdown, outro)
- On CDJ: jump between them with the **search arrows**
- Unlimited — be generous
- One is the **load point** (where the track cues on load)

For finding your place & timing transitions.

👉 HOT CUE = YOUR HANDS

Use to **perform** — instant one-tap jumps.

- Loaded on the **A–H pads** (8 on FLX4 = 8 on CDJ-3000)
- Smash to the drop, fire a vocal, reload, loop-in
- Max 8 — reserve for things you trigger live
- Shown as coloured markers on the waveform

For live triggers you hit with your fingers.

The pro move: set the drop, mix-in, mix-out & breakdown as **BOTH**. Right-click a Hot Cue → **Save as Memory Cue**. Now they work on every player and one tap / one arrow away.

2 · THE PAD MAP (A–H) — WHEN YOU USE EACH

PAD	CUE	COLOUR	WHEN YOU USE IT	BOTH?
A	Mix-IN	● Green	First clean downbeat — load & beatmatch in from here	✓
B	Build-up	● Yellow	Skip straight into the riser/tension	—
C	Drop	● Red	Money cue — jump crowd to the drop / reload	✓
D	Vocal / hook	● Purple	Fire the hook or acapella moment (mashups)	—
E	Breakdown	● Blue	Drop energy / set up the next transition	✓
F	2nd drop	● Red	Skip forward to the next peak	—
G	Mix-OUT	○ White	Where you START blending out — never overstay	✓
H	Loop / reload / mashup layer	● Cyan	Loop-in, reload trigger, or launch a mashup layer	—

Short on time? Cue only **A (mix-in), C (drop), G (mix-out)** as Hot + Memory. That alone makes a track gig-ready.

3 · THE TAGGING TOOLS — WHEN TO USE EACH

TOOL	WHEN TO USE IT	EXAMPLE
 Comment	Track-specific instructions you want to read on the CDJ screen while browsing	<i>MASH → Titanium acap @ drop 8A HC-H</i>
 My Tag	Filter your library fast — pull up a vibe mid-set in one click	Energy 1–5 · Vocal/Instr · Genre · Mashup-ready
 Colour	Visual grouping — spot related tracks without reading	Same colour = both halves of a mashup pair
 Rating	Quality / priority — sort to grab bangers first	5★ = floor-filler · 3★ = filler · 1★ = maybe
 Playlist	Order & sets — this is what you export to USB	SETS · MASHUPS · CRATES folders

4 · PER-TRACK PREP ORDER (DO THE SAME EVERY TIME)

1. **Analyze** → check the beatgrid downbeat sits on beat 1
2. **Quantize ON**
3. Set **A / C / G** (mix-in, drop, mix-out) as Hot + Memory — the non-negotiables
4. Add **B, D, E, F, H** if the track needs them
5. **Colour** the Hot Cues per the map
6. Fill the **Comment**, add **My Tags**, set a **Rating**
7. Drag into the right **Playlist**
8. Playlists done → **export to the gig USB** (re-export after ANY change)

Prep your next 20–30 tracks first — not the whole library at once.

5 · HARMONIC MIXING QUICK-REF (FOR CLEAN MIXES & MASHUPS)

WHAT KEYS BLEND

Same key	8A → 8A · perfect
±1 on wheel	8A → 7A or 9A · smooth
Relative maj/min	8A ↔ 8B · mood shift
+7 (energy boost)	8A → 3A · lifts the room

Acapella must match the instrumental's key (or key-shift it).

TEMPO (BPM)

- Within **±6%** pitches cleanly
- Bigger gap → use **half / double time** (e.g. 140 over ~70)
- Sort a playlist by **Key** or **BPM** — compatible neighbours jump out

*Mashup = compatible key **and** tempo, then mark the in/out cues on both tracks.*